



Khronos Group releases OpenCL 1.1

The Khronos Group, an industry consortium set up to create open standards, has ratified version 1.1 of the OpenCL (Open Computing Language) standard, which defines an interface for heterogeneous parallel computers designed to allow the development of applications and functions that run on different (but OpenCL-compliant) processors. Apart from 2D and 3D graphics acceleration, OpenCL is also designed to utilise the potential of graphics processors for general purpose applications. More at: <http://bit.ly/OpenCL>



OpenCL

FFmpeg 0.6 adds WebM/VP8 support



The developers of the FFmpeg project have released FFmpeg 0.6, code-named 'Works with HTML5'. As the code name suggests, the major update features a number of improvements related to HTML5 video, and adds support for the latest open (Google) WebM/VP8 video format. The H.264 and Theora decoders are 'significantly faster', and the Vorbis decoder has also received important updates. More at: <http://bit.ly/FFmpeg>

NetBeans IDE 6.9 arrives

The NetBeans development team has released version 6.9 of the open source development environment, which includes a new JavaFX Composer (a visual layout tool for GUI applications). It can be used to write, edit and test Rich Internet Applications (RIA) built using Oracle's JavaFX, and to bind components to different data types (such as Web services). The new version supports the latest JavaFX 1.3. More at: <http://bit.ly/NetBeansIDE>

Transmission 2.00 BitTorrent client released

Transmission version 2.00 includes a number of improvements and new features, and addresses several bugs found in the previous 1.93 release. It features 'Local Peer Discovery' to find other peers on a user's local network; smarter heuristics to connect to peers; and various platform-specific changes. More at: <http://bit.ly/BitTorrent>



Zorin 3 - Distro Review

Zorin is an Ubuntu-based distro that focuses on easing a Windows user's transition to Linux by making its interface look like Microsoft's operating system. Zorin 3 is based on the recently released Ubuntu 10.04, and by default looks very similar to Windows 7. Read the rest of this review at: <http://bit.ly/Zorin3>

MonoDevelop 2.4 released

MonoDevelop 2.4 includes a number of new features and improvements: better pad organisation, auto-hiding pads like the Error List, logs for version control or 'Find in Files' operations, and several user interface (UI) improvements. According to a blog post by project leader Miguel de Icaza, MonoDevelop 2.4 supports Gtk#, ASP.NET MVC, Silverlight, MonoMac and MonoTouch deployments from the same IDE.

Improvements relate to source editing, the debugger and add-ins. Other changes include new *Project/File* and *Navigate To* dialogues, support for WCF (Windows Communication Foundation) Web References and more. More at: <http://bit.ly/MonoDevelop>

India to forge coalition to fight ACTA

India has now announced that it is going to forge its own anti-ACTA coalition in an effort to undermine the new treaty. ACTA is a capitalistic treaty that aims to implement several measures that will seriously hurt people's freedoms, rights, and privacy. It seeks to widen the scope of protection and sets higher standards for enforcement of intellectual property rights, beyond the provisions of the existing multilateral TRIPS agreement. It poses a major threat to India and other developing nations, but because these nations are not included in the ACTA talks, they can't influence its direction. The US, the EU, Canada, Japan, Australia, Korea, New Zealand, and Switzerland seem to be working to create an agreement which only benefits them; they can later pressure developing nations into signing it, by threatening to impose import bans or other action. More at: <http://bit.ly/antiACTA1> and <http://bit.ly/antiACTA2>

Parted Magic partitioning tool updated

Developer Patrick Verner has released version 4.11 of his open source, multi-platform partitioning tool that can be used to create, move, delete and resize drive partitions. It includes support for NTFS, FAT, ReiserFS, Reiser4 and HFS+, and also for LVM and RAID. Based on kernel 2.6.32.15, the new version adds the Clonezilla open source clone system (OCS), Perl 5.10.1 and vmfs-tools 0.2.1. Updates include the Chromium Web browser version 6.0.424.0, FSArchiver 0.6.10, NTFS-3G 2010.5.22 and Parted 2.3. More at: <http://bit.ly/PartedMagic>